

Introduction To Christ Presbyterian Church, New Haven



Three Core Values

- *Our Ambition: To **Glorify** God!*

- *A Christ Centered Ministry*

- *Our Confidence: The **Gospel***

- *A Gospel Driven Church Culture*

- *Our Strategy: The **Church***

- *A “Churchy” Strategy*

Why “To Glorify God?”

- ✓ It is the ultimate imperative that directs all of Redemptive History (Ps.86:9)
- ✓ It is the ultimate passion of Christ...(Jn12:28)
- ✓ It is the ultimate purpose of the kingdom of God and the church... (tit.2:13, Rev.1:6)
- ✓ It is the ultimate prayer of all true believers... (Jude 1:24ff)

Why “To Glorify God?”

Because God alone is Worthy!

After describing God as one who is *infinite in being and perfection... immense, eternal, incomprehensible, almighty, most wise, most holy, most free, most absolute... most righteous, most loving, gracious, merciful... all-sufficient not standing in need of any creature which he hath made, not deriving any glory from them but only manifesting his own glory in, by, unto and upon them... as nothing is to him contingent or uncertain, etc. etc* -- the confession is compelled to add, *to Him is due from angels and men, and every other creature, whatsoever worship, service or obedience he is pleased to require of them.*

What will it take?

Three Christian Observations:

1. Our inability to glorifying God

A ruler questioned Him, saying, "Good Teacher, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?" And Jesus said to him, "Why do you call Me good? No one is good except God alone.

Luke 18:18-19

Three Christian Observations: (cont.)

2. *What is for us impossible, is not impossible for God!*

But He said, "The things that are impossible with people are possible with God."

Luke 18:27

Three Christian Observations: (cont.)

3. The possibility of glorifying God by faith in Christ alone!

For it is impossible for the blood of bulls and goats to take away sins.

Heb. 10:4

And without faith it is impossible to please *Him*, for he who comes to God must believe that He is and *that* He is a rewarder of those who seek Him.

Heb. 11:6

God is only *Really* Glorified In Jesus Christ

When he had gone out, Jesus said, “Now the Son of Man has been glorified, and God has been glorified in him. 32 If God has been glorified in him, God will also glorify him in himself and will glorify him at once.

John 13:31

A Christ Centered Vision:

- ✓ A Christ Centered **Culture**: From *meisms* to *Christisms* in *method, message, mediums...*
- ✓ A Christ Centered **Message**: A Church that reads all of scripture as pointing to Christ rather than men/women.
- ✓ A Christ Centered **Worship**: A Church that shuns a “worship for” vs. a “for worship” orientation.
- ✓ A Christ Centered **Evangelism**: Where doxology IS Good Evangelism

An Interesting Testimony...

Why Doxology is Evangelism...

The world had not satisfied me the way it had promised, the way I had anticipated. The world's message and methods had hung me out to dry. I hungered desperately for something-- Something, "out of this world." (I was) broken and longing for something transcendent... I was very thankful when I walked into a church that was very different: A church where the otherness of God was sensed immediately. In the music, in the message and in the mingling afterward, it was clear that God was the guest of honor there... I had suffered the consequences of the modern world's emphasis on the individual and I was unbelievably refreshed to discover a place that took the focus off of me and put it on him... I was drawn in by the glorious mystery of it all. I was being evangelized, not by a man-centered show, but by a God-centered atmosphere... it was quite literally, "out of this world."

W. Tullian Tchividjian

Our Confidence: The Gospel

- The Gospel is the Power of God

For I am not ashamed of the gospel; it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who has faith, to the Jew first and also to the Greek. Rom.1:16

- The Gospel Effects Everything

Only, live your life in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ...
Phil.1:27

- The Gospel is both Message *and* Life Transformation

Our message of the gospel came to you not in word only, but also in power and in the Holy Spirit and with full conviction; just as you know what kind of persons we proved to be among you for your sake. 1Th.1:5

What is the Gospel?

The gospel is the supernatural power of God unto salvation wherein the life of God is given to all who believe in Jesus Christ. It is the free gift of God's grace and possessed by faith alone. The life of God that is given to us includes both eternal life after this life, and also an increasingly transformed life in the present.

What is the **Gospel**? (cont.)

- ✓ *The **gospel** is not just “theology,” but the way we do theology.*
- ✓ *The **gospel** is not just a message to believe, but a transforming power we possess that changes our approach to relationships, motives for doing what we do, suffering hardship, our approach to the world.*
- ✓ *In short, the **gospel** is our approach to everything!*
- ✓ *We desire to be a **gospel** centered church wherein the gospel exudes through everything we do as a church and individually.*

A Gospel Vision

What would it look like?

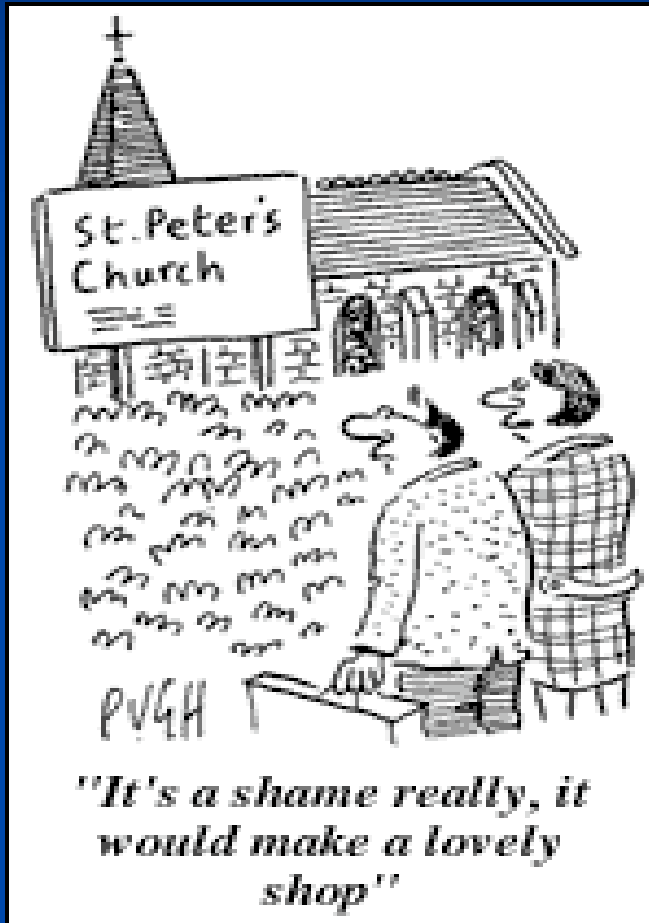
- ✓ Changes how we relate to God
- ✓ Changes how we grow in holiness
- ✓ Changes the way we think about suffering and weakness
- ✓ Changes how we relate to one another in the church
- ✓ Changes the way we relate to people in the world and witness

In sum...

*The **gospel** is not just the “A-B-C” but the “A-to-Z” of the Christian life. The gospel is not just the way to enter the kingdom, but is the way to address every problem and is the way to grow at every step. If we believe we can find our own worth and meaning through performance, then we will become either proud and disdainful of others (if we reach our goals), or else discouraged and self-loathing (if we fail our goals). But the **gospel** creates an entirely new self-image... , it tells us that we are more wicked than we ever dared believe, but more loved and accepted in Christ than we ever dared to hope—at the same time.*

Tim Keller

A *Churchy* Strategy?????



- 80% of Americans say you don't have to go to church to be a Christian.
- 77% of students at Yale agree that their spirituality doesn't depend on being involved in a religious organization.

A *Churchy* Strategy

Why?

Because the Church is *Essential* To The Gospel!

- ✓ Salvation is both individual and corporate- Eph.2
- ✓ Salvation involves a mediated presence of God, provisionally in the present age anticipating its consummation in the age to come. 1Cor.6:16, Rev. 21:3
- ✓ Apostolic Example in Missions- Acts 9:31
- ✓ Church is the appointed guardian of the faith- 1 Tim.3:15

In Sum...

The whole of the Bible—as the book of redemption, is “not (merely) the story of ideas about God, but the story of the people of God...the gospel does not come to each of us in isolation. It comes to us through a particular book and through a particular fellowship... it is a false spirituality, divorced from the whole teaching of the Bible which regards this visible and continuing church as of subordinate importance for the life of Christ... God meets us through his people here and now in the form of an actual invitation into the fellowship of a body of people calling themselves one Church.

Lesslie Newbigin, *The Reunion of the Church*

The Relation of **Christ** And Church

The Church Is the
Mediatorial Body of Christ!

- ✓ Christ Mediated in Word as Prophet-- Rom.10:14ff
- ✓ Christ Mediated in Sacramental Worship as Priest-- 1Cor.10:16ff
- ✓ Christ Mediated in Government and “one anothering” as King-- 1 Peter 5:2ff

A Church Strategy would have an ...

✓ Organic Model for Ministry

In 1 Corinthians 12, Paul uses the metaphor of a body to emphasize the fact that we belong to one another and need each other. We are all baptized in the one Spirit and as partakers of that one Spirit are to be seen as intimately related and connected to one another. We are not to say “I don’t need you” to anyone within the community. We are affected by what is going on in one another’s lives whether we know it or not: “If one part suffers, every part suffers with it; if one part is honored every part rejoices with it.

See also Romans 12

A Church strategy would have an... (cont.)

✓ Organic Model of doing pastoral care

love one another with mutual affection; outdo one another in showing honor.
Rom. 12:10

- A church OF small groups
- Cooperative system of care giving between lay and ordained
- Regular Pastoral Visitation

✓ Organic Model for Evangelism

But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, God's own people, in order that you may proclaim the mighty acts of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light. 1 Peter 2:9

- Collaborative approach-- lay witnessing and authorized preaching
- Household Evangelism
- Mercy and Evangelism

In sum, the church is fellowship is...

... vital for our spiritual health and central to the church's true life. It is two dimensional, and it is vertical before it can be horizontal. That is we must know the reality of fellowship with the Father and his Son Jesus Christ before we can know the reality of fellowship with each other in our common relationship to God. Christian fellowship is seeking to share with others what God has made known of him to you, while letting them share with you what they know of him as a means of finding strength, refreshment and instruction for one's own soul. Gratefully one receives what others share. Equally, one labors to give. And in the giving, no less than in the taking, one finds renewal and strength. Fellowship is an expression of both love and humility. It springs from a desire to bring benefit to others coupled with a sense of personal weakness and need. It has a double motive: the wish to help and the wish to be helped, the wish to edify and the wish to be edified. It is thus a corporate seeking by Christian people to know God better through sharing with each other what individually they have learned already.

J.I. Packer

A Christian View of Life

What do YOU think should be included?

- ✓ A point of view about...
- ✓ A point of view about...
- ✓ A point of view about...
- ✓ Etc.
- ✓ Etc.

Our Five Basic Commitments

Reflecting our “Point of View”

- I. Our Commitment to being *Biblical*.
- II. Our Commitment to the *teachings of grace*.
- III. Our Commitment to *Christ-Centered Sacramental Worship*.
- IV. Our Commitment to Being *Missional*.
- V. Our Commitment to *Christian calling* in three spheres-- public service, family, church.

Our Commitment to being *Biblical*

We are committed to the Old and New Testament Scriptures as our only rule of faith and practice.

While believing that God powerfully manifest his infinite glory in a general way through creation, our Christian faith and practice is grounded in God's works of redemption in history as explained to us through the divinely appointed means of inspired Scripture. We believe that all things necessary for salvation are sufficiently revealed to us by the Holy Spirit speaking through the Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments. We believe also that all special revelation has ceased until the next and final redemptive act of God in history when Christ will return to judge the living and the dead. It is, therefore, our ambition to teach the whole counsel of God's word, not adding to, or subtracting from, anything contained within it, recognizing no other source for divine revelation, whether by ecclesiastical traditions or private revelations.

Two Complimentary “Books” of Revelation

Parity in substance, disparity in content!

(compare Ps.19, Rom.1:18ff, 1Tim.3:15ff)

The book of revelation and the book of nature are both from God and will be found when both are adequately interpreted to coincide perfectly.... The one (revelation in the bible) was designed and is admirably adapted to lay the foundation of an intelligent faith in Jehovah as the absolute Creator and the immediate former and providential ruler of all things. But it was not designed either to prevent or to take the place of scientific interpretation of all existing phenomena and of all traces of the past history of the world which God allows men to discover. Apparent discrepancies in established truths can have their ground only in perfect knowledge. God requires us both to believe and to learn. He imposes upon us at present the necessity of humility and patience.

A. A. Hodge, *The Confession Of Faith*

Expositional Style Sermons

- ✓ Right message *from the right text* (2Tim.2:15)
- ✓ Biblical counsel *in Biblical proportions* (Acts 2:27)
- ✓ Assumes the burden of “thus saith the Lord.” (1 Cor.1:20, Neh.1:1-8)

“It is required of those that hear the Word preached, that they attend upon it with diligence, preparation, and prayer; EXAMINE WHAT THEY HEAR BY THE SCRIPTURES; receive the truth with faith, love, meekness, and readiness of mind, as the Word of God; meditate, and confer of it; hide it in their hearts, and bring forth the fruit of it in their lives.”

- ✓ Redemptive Historical-- all roads lead to Christ (Luke 24:13ff *Emmaus Road Conversation*)
- ✓ God centered-- Ultimate *hero* is God acting in history!
- ✓ The sufficiency of Scripture (2Tim.3:16)
- ✓ Demonstrations of the power of the Gospel unto salvation!

A Confessional Consensus *Seem odd?*

Boston College social analyst Alan Wolfe's *The Transformation of American Religion: How We Actually Live Our Faith*

Wolfe says most Americans are amiable souls in matters of religion, too, and that the powerful American culture sands down the rough edges of how believers behave, regardless of what official creeds might command."

American religion is generally individualistic, uninterested in doctrine, distrustful toward tradition and institutions, practical and ``increasingly at home with the culture surrounding it."

(Associated Press-- Religion in the News)

Why Use Church Confessions?

- If not unity of confession, then unity of what?
 - Amos 3:3, "How can two walk together unless they be agreed?"
 - Phil. 1:27, "stand fast in one spirit with one mind"
 - Eph.4:13, "until all of us come to the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the son of God.
- As a basis for instruction
 - 1 Tim. 4:6, *If you put these instructions before the brothers and sisters, you will be a good servant of Christ Jesus, nourished on the words of faith and of the sound teaching that you have followed.*
 - 2 Thess.2:15, *So then, brothers and sisters, stand firm and hold fast to the traditions that you were taught by us, either by word of mouth or by our letter.*

Why Confessions (cont.)?

- In order to preserve the faith against false teaching
 - *2 Tim.4:3, For the time is coming when people will not put up with sound doctrine, but having itching ears, they will accumulate for themselves teachers to suit their own desires.*
 - *Romans 10:2, they have a zeal for God but not according to knowledge.*
 - *2John 1:10 Do not receive into the house or welcome anyone who comes to you and does not bring this teaching;*
- In order to be candid
 - *Romans 10:2, they have a zeal for God but not according to knowledge*
 - *2Tim. 2:2 and what you have heard from me through many witnesses entrust to faithful people who will be able to teach others as well.*

Our Commitment to the *teachings of grace*

We are committed to the teachings of grace as they are summarized in the historic Westminster Confession of Faith.

Whereas the Holy Scriptures is our *only* rule of faith and practice, our Church unity is predicated upon a consensus about what the Scriptures principally teach. Our consensus is reflected in the 350—year--old *Westminster Confession of Faith*. In summary, it affirms that God is no less sovereign in our salvation than He is sovereign in our creation to the praise of God's glorious grace! This means that we are accepted by God, from beginning to end, not by our own works or attempts at being approved by God, but by faith alone in the perfect and all sufficient work of Christ on our behalf, faith itself being the free gift of God! While many people join our church without knowing or affirming all the teachings contained in the *Westminster Confession of Faith*, our church, when acting and speaking corporately, seeks to be in accord with the Westminster Standards.

Sovereignty And Grace TOGETHER

*Those of mankind that are predestinated unto life, God, before the foundation of the world was laid, according to his eternal and immutable purpose, and the secret counsel and good pleasure of his will, hath chosen, in Christ, unto everlasting glory, out of his **mere** free grace and love, without any foresight of faith, or good works, or perseverance in either of them, or any other thing in the creature, as conditions, or causes moving him thereunto; and all to the praise of his glorious grace.*

WCF 3.5

Our Commitment to *Christ-Centered & Sacramental Worship*

We are committed to God-centered worship designed after a covenantal pattern that is in the mediated presence of Christ through word and sacrament.

In every period of redemptive history, God has chosen to mediate his saving presence among his people as regulated through the divine institutions of word, sacrament, fellowship and prayers. Today, through the sacraments of the Lord's Supper and Christian Baptism, together with the preaching of God's word and corporate prayers (both sung and unsung), God has promised to be with us until the end of the age. Our worship is set to the pattern of covenant initiation and renewal including the weekly participation of the Lord's supper. Our music and style of worship is "blended" to reflect the multi-cultural context of those God has brought to our city. Our desire is for our worship to be as God-centered as our theology, communicating the truth and grace of God to the nations. We welcome all believers together with those who are searching.

Four Dialogical Movements

From Transcendence to Immanence to Transcendence

Movement of Praise and Adoration

- Call to Worship
- Doxology
- Hymns/Songs of Praise
- Prayer of Praise and Invocation

praise is the gateway to God's presence

Hughes Old

Four Dialogical Movements (cont.)

From Transcendence to Immanence to Transcendence

Movement of Confession and Absolution

- Reading of the Law of God
- Confession of Sin
- Assurance and Absolution
- Entrance Sacrament of Baptism
- Pastoral Prayers
- Hymns/Songs of Thanksgiving

as true knowledge of God leads to a true knowledge of ourselves.

Terry Johnson

As a consequence, we must infer that man is never sufficiently touched and affected by the awareness of his lowly state until he has compared himself with God's majesty."

John Calvin, *Institutes*

Dialogical Movements (cont.)

From Transcendence to Immanence to Transcendence

Movement in *Word* and *Sacrament*:
“the mediatorial means of grace”

- Reading from Scripture
- Prayer for Illumination
- Expository Sermon
- Renewed Faith in Christ
- Renewed Trust and Giving of ourselves To Christ
- Sacrament of Lord's Supper and Spiritual Confirmation and Sealing into Gods' Salvation

It is not merely a re-enactment or remembrance of God's work for our salvation. It is God present as mediated through his word and sacrament so as to transact his covenant to those who are being saved.

Dialogical Movements (cont.)

From Transcendence to Immanence to Transcendence

Movement of Divine Coronation and Benediction

- Hymn of Coronation and Praise
- Prayer of Coronation, Praise and Thanksgiving
- Gloria Patri
- Benediction: The final Word is God's, and it is the promise of blessing, not curse, upon those being saved!

*every creature which is in heaven and earth and under the earth... said,
Blessing and honor and glory and power to Him who sits on the throne,
and to the Lamb forever and ever!*

Rev. 5:12-13

Covenantal Worship Principles...

Sacramental Principle

Corporate worship is set apart from all other Christian events by the mediated presence of God “in our midst” through the ministry of word, sacrament and prayers. The whole service is within the shadow of koinonia as climaxed in the weekly Lord’s Supper.

The cup of blessing that we bless, is it not a sharing in the blood of Christ? The bread that we break, is it not a sharing in the body of Christ?

1 Cor.16-17

Covenantal Worship Principles... (cont.)

Regulative Principle- Elements of Worship

The light of nature shows that there is a God, who has lordship and sovereignty over all, is good, and does good unto all, and is therefore to be feared, loved, praised, called upon, trusted in, and served, with all the heart, and with all the soul, and with all the might. *But the acceptable way of worshipping the true God is instituted by Himself, and so limited by His own revealed will, that He may not be worshipped according to the imaginations and devices of men, or the suggestions of Satan, under any visible representation, or any other way not prescribed in the holy Scripture.* WCF 21.1

4 Essential Elements: (Acts 2:42)

- Prayers (Spoken and Sung)
- Sacraments (Baptism-entrance, Lord's Supper- Renewal)
- Word (Apostolic) Read and Preached
- "Fellowship" (Collection and Mercy)

Covenantal Worship Principles... (cont.)

Directed Principle- Forms of Worship

*Nevertheless, we acknowledge the inward illumination of the Spirit of God to be necessary for the saving understanding of such things as are revealed in the Word: and that there are some circumstances concerning the worship of God, and government of the church, **common to human actions and societies**, which are to be ordered by the light of nature, and Christian prudence, according to the general rules of the Word, which are always to be observed. WCF 1:6*

- ❖ Formalism-- Forms are regulated/Prescribed
- ❖ Formlessness-- Forms are Unregulated/Disdained
- ❖ Directory-- Forms are Affirmed as generally directed by Scripture and specifically applied locally

Covenantal Worship Principles... (cont.)

Vernacular Principle-- *Blended* Style of Worship
and the Call to Greater Charity!

In so far as it is a work of the people in response to the work of God, there is a "vernacular" component to true, dialogical, nature of worship. In an increasingly multi-cultural context, there will necessarily be a multi-cultural vernacular and greater need for vernacular tolerance as driven by love.

Therefore do not let what is for you a good thing be spoken of as evil; for the kingdom of God is not eating and drinking, but righteousness and peace and joy in the Holy Spirit. For he who in this way serves Christ is acceptable to God and approved by men. So then let us pursue the things which make for peace and the building up of one another.

Romans 14:16-19

Covenantal Worship Principles... (cont.)

The “Faith” Principle in Worship

Covenantal worship pertains to BOTH covenant *Initiation* and *renewal*. Whereas the service will want to target the “faith sympathies” granted by the Holy Spirit (vs. unbelieving sympathies) this is not to be confused with targeting only “believers.” A good service will speak to both the church and unchurched, even as the elect consist of both believers and “not yet believers” alike.

Our Commitment to Being *Missional*

We are committed to being a missional, multi-cultural church and church planting movement.

We believe that the church, the household of God, is an essential element of the gospel into which people of every tribe and nation are welcomed. While affirming that every follower of Christ is called to be a witness to the truth and grace of God revealed in Jesus Christ in both word and deed, we also believe that true evangelism is best accomplished organically through church and by church planting. It is therefore our ambition to be not only a growing church, but also a growing church planting movement. While holding to a time-honored understanding of faith, we are strategically progressive. Our aim is to plant churches that reach the different cultures in our city, New England and the world.

Great Commission Culture

Missional vs. Maintenance

Missional-- focus is to open doors into the world for the sake of sharing and participating in the gospel. Try to avoid Christianeze...

Maintenance-- structure, programs and focus is on building walls in order to keep the world out. Celebrates Christianeze...

Missional --prayer focus on a harvest of the gospel and gospel transformation by means of x,y, z. circumstance

Maintenance -- prayer on members needs only and on z,y,z circumstances only.

Missional -- teaching with outreach objectives in mind.

Maintenance -- teaching with focus on ourselves and meeting our personal needs only.

Missional -- loves its community and seeks to reach it

Maintenance -- fears its community and seeks to protect ourselves from it.

Missional -- tired but loving it... to busy for internal divisiveness

Maintenance -- fatigue and frustration ...internal divisions

Missional -- Emphasis on “guarding” the faith for the sake of the gospel of grace for sinners.

Maintenance -- Emphasis on guarding the faith only, dominated by special interest theology

The Mission Church

In a *Post-Christendom* Culture

- ❖ Discourse in the common language and style without loss of Christian categories
 - ❖ Avoids “we-them” discourse
 - ❖ As if the whole neighborhood is present
 - ❖ Avoid “tribal” cliches and unpack classic terms
- ❖ Counter Cultural and Counter Intuitive
 - ❖ Radically Christian and progressive
 - ❖ Other-worldly and pro-world
 - ❖ Truth with compassion

Our Commitment to *Christian calling* in three spheres-- public service, family, church

We are committed to a high view of Christian calling as reflected in the vocational spheres of family, church and public service.

We believe that God has placed into our lives the boundaries of our habitation that reflect his own sovereign design to accomplish his work in the world. His work extends into the spheres of family, church and civil vocations. We desire to help people find a balance that is unique to their individual callings which reflects a high view of vocation and calling in these three spheres of service. While believing that the Christian Scriptures does *not* address all things pertaining to life in this world, we do affirm that we should take “every thought captive to the obedience of Christ” and that the Christian worldview is applicable and relevant to all spheres of life. Our ultimate commitment is to the restoration of “calling” that we might more and more glorify God and enjoy Him forever!

Christian Calling(s)

Christian Calling

1Cor.1:9

The Imitation of Christ

Eph.5:1-2

Christian Callings

1Cor.7:17, 20

Public Service

Rom.13:1ff

Church Service

Rom.12:1ff

Family Service

Eph.5:21ff

The ART in Work

Work is not, primarily, a thing one does to live, but the thing one lives to do... it is the full expression of the worker's faculties, the thing in which he finds spiritual, mental and bodily satisfaction and the medium in which he offers himself to God...

Thus, as made in the image of God... all men are made so far artists as to desire the integrity of the work.... This is another way of saying that the work must be measured by the standard of eternity, or that it must be done for God first and foremost...

Dorothy Sayers

Gen. 2:2-3...

Three Dynamics For Decision Making

The human mind plans the way, but the LORD directs the steps.

Prov. 16:9

- ✓ **Biblical Values and Worldview (2 Cor.10:5)**
 - ✓ Biblical View of Three Sphere Calling and each sphere specifically
 - ✓ Biblical View of Grace-- “Common and Special”
 - ✓ Biblical View of the Kingdom of God and the World
- ✓ **Personal Aspects (Psm 139:13-16)**
 - ✓ Personal Passions
 - ✓ Personal Giftedness
 - ✓ Personal Experience and Training
- ✓ **Contextual Factors (Psm. 139:5, Acts 17:26)**
 - ✓ Noble dreams
 - ✓ Opportunities
 - ✓ Issues relevant to other spheres

Systems Approach to Divine Guidance

God is in the "system"

- There IS an individual and specific plan for every Christian.
- It is strictly and intentionally kept secret... God does NOT normally reveal anything about it to us...
- Divine guidance has nothing to do with discerning this secret plan and using it to make decisions.
- Guidance is given by God when he gives us insight into issues and choices so that we make the decisions with divinely inspired wisdom. Guidance comes, in short, by God making us wise... there is no seeking for the clues or signs, there is no need for a direct word...
- An approach that stresses the Sufficiency of Scripture coupled with divine Providence over time, Godly counsel
- Step by step—God is in the system therefore we trust that he will guide us to discover his perfect and good will *step by step*.

(Col.1:9-10, Philip.1:9-11, Eph.5:15-17, James 1:5-7, 13-17)

Further Reading:

Papers and Books

- *Centrality of the Gospel*, Tim Keller (CPC Website)
- *Basic Questions*, Preston Graham (CPC Website)
- *Basic Christianity*, John Stott

Scripture

- To Know Christ: *The Gospel of John*
- To Understand the Church: *The Letter to the Ephesians*